

Iven Shishkalov

Software & Cloud Engineer (Distributed infra, multi-cloud)

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summary

Software & Cloud Engineer with 7+ years of experience. I've built managed Kubernetes platforms across public and private clouds, focusing on multi-cloud networking and workload scheduling. I enjoy bending clouds and K8s to new compute and networking demands: giving unpredictable workloads the contained autonomy to pursue complex goals and fail safely.

experience

Research Engineer, Infra

Mar 2026 - Present

Rynv New York, US (Remote)

- Research and design multi-cloud sandbox infrastructure for AI agents and untrusted code in customer-owned clouds (BYOC)

Technical Co-Founder

Aug 2025 - Feb 2026

Stealth Healthtech Startup London, UK (Remote)

- Built a multi-step ingestion pipeline for a knowledge corpus made of research papers, expert Q&A recordings, and articles. Transcription, cleaning, LLM-as-a-judge relevance scoring, chunking, hybrid retrieval using Qdrant
- Implemented agent memory and context manager beyond RAG: KG, sleep-time compute for between-session reasoning, re-anchoring of critical context, agent durability with Temporal, guardrails on a finetuned safety classifier, evals with deepeval
- Designed a PII de-identification layer that uses generalization, pseudonymization with identity domain separation, per-user crypto shredding (data irrecoverable even in backups), ensuring compliance with GDPR and EU AI Act
- Shipped a low-latency voice agent (Livekit, ElevenLabs) and a React/Next.js PWA on self-hosted Kubernetes with KEDA autoscaling

Founding Engineer, CTO

May 2023 - Oct 2025

Software Vrienden Deventer, NL

- Led engineering through multiple pivots from a manual recruiting agency to an AI-matching tech platform & SaaS
- Architected and shipped LLM-assisted matching that cut false-positive matches by 75%; built a custom jobs crawling/scraping engine allowing non-engineers to launch new scrapers in 5 minutes; increased job ingestion by ~10x
- Brought our cloud bill to \$0 for 2 years while modernizing the platform and reinvesting \$30k+ annual savings into product
- Replaced Notion-backed ops databases with a Dagster ETL, removing rate limits and cutting API latency from ~10s to <200ms
- Built internal RAG and tools to accelerate sales; helped close a €100k pre-seed round; led a remote team of 5 engineers

Cloud Platform Owner, Product Owner (part-time contract)

Jan 2024 - Dec 2024

Improvers (subsidiary of Essent) Utrecht, NL

- Owned the technical roadmap to productize an internal Salesforce-wrapper tool into a SaaS for 200+ paying customers
- Built a self-service platform from zero on AWS (EKS/Lambda) for 100+ microservices, taking zero-to-prod from days to minutes
- Cut AWS spend by ~60% through autoscaling, spot strategy and rightsizing, while keeping delivery speed high
- Embedded privacy-by-design and security guardrails into CI/CD (wrote a custom Jenkins lib for safe-defaults, secret injection, auditability), and coached dev teams

Software Engineer

Nov 2021 - May 2023

Avisi Cloud Arnhem, NL

- Prototyped multi-cluster fleet management for AME, researching secure connectivity and workload distribution across public and private clouds
- Took ownership of the billing & self-service layers to launch an enterprise-grade managed Kubernetes PaaS in 6 months
- Built the usage-based billing engine from scratch, public (REST) and internal (gRPC) APIs with Go, Java, NATS, Stripe
- Built the self-service flow (Angular, Spring) and personally demoed at KubeCon booth, securing the first 30+ signups

Associate Software Engineer

Jan 2019 - Jan 2021

TomTom Amsterdam, NL

- Built release tooling (Node.js, Angular) and automations that cut coordination effort by 50% across 20+ engineering teams

education

BSc Information & Communication Technology

2017 - 2022

Saxion University of Applied Sciences Deventer, NL

- Bachelor's thesis, graded 10/10: Multicloud Kubernetes Architectures - Networking & Scheduling; GPA 3.8/4.0

skills

code	Go, Python, Java, Node.js, Angular, React, Astro
ai/ml	RAG, MLOps, evals (deepeval), guardrails, agent sandboxes, MCPs, durable agents
cloud/infra	Kubernetes (EKS, GKE, bare-metal, BYOC), multi-cloud, AWS, GCP, OVH, GPUs, FinOps, Terraform, Helm
data	Postgres, Qdrant, CockroachDB, Redis, NATS, RabbitMQ, Dagster, Meilisearch
platforms & dx	Backstage, GitOps, ArgoCD, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, GitLab CI, Prometheus, Sentry, Temporal